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Happy Birthday Api!!

Some people pass through this world quietly and yet leave behind a kind of beauty that can't be ignored like the soft glow of a waning moon trembling across the surface of still water. Their presence doesn't demand attention, yet it reshapes the air around them. Their character lingers in the hearts of others long after they leave a room, the way the frangrance of rain lingers after a storm. Their existence itself feels like a mercy sent gently from above. You are one of those rare people.

Writing this Birthday note, I find myself at a loss because ordinary words feel too small, like trying to hold an ocean in a cup. How does one properly speak of a person who carries so much grace, so much talent and so much goodness within them? How does one explain the comfort of knowing that such a soul exists in the world; steady and luminous, like a quiet lighthouse guiding ships that nevere even realised they were being guided?

You are in every sense, deeply special. Not only because of how gifted you are, but because of the kind of person you are beneath that. Some people make the world a better place just by being in it, the way spring arrives and the world feels lighter & more vibrant without exactly knowing why. You are not only among those people, you are one of the very best of them.

There are times I genuinely wonder what deed of mine Allah looked at with mercy, what small unnoticed

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goodness He accepted from me, that he chose to place someone like you in my path. To have someone so talented, so admirable, so full of light, light that glows softly rather than burn brightly, as a mentor, as a senior and someone who came to feel like an elder sister to me... that is not something I could ever take lightly.

On this day, I pray Allah grants you a life as beautiful as your soul. I pray he fills your path with ease, your years with barakah and your soul with with peace that settles deep, like calm waters after a storm. I pray your talents continue to flourish like a garden that knows no drought, that your efforts are rewarded in ways beyond your imagination and that you are always protected from the harshness of this world.

You are and always will be cooler than Antarctica, But even that comparison feels unfair. Antarctica may stand at the furthest edge of cold, the highest point on the scale, a continent of ice and endless frost, yet even that vast whiteness falls short. There is no scale wide enough to measure your coolness. Antarctica may be the coldest place we know, but it is still limited by numbers; you are not. Even Antarctica, with all its frozen pride, is falling behind.

So today, I simply say this:

Thankyou for being who you are, steady like the horizon, gentle like the moonlight

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on waves. Thankyou for existing as gracefully as you do.

Happy Birthday to one of the rarest souls this world has been blessed with and the best senior, mentor and elder sister one could ask for!

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